THE TRIBUNE

SERVING THE GREATER BAY AREA FROM OAKLAND SINCE 1874

Oakland, California | Friday, March 16, 1984 | Home delivery $8 a month

Gunman shot at White House

Column One

Volunteers rally in hunt for Kevin

Hundreds pull together, but search still fruitless

By Terry Link
The Tribune

SAN FRANCISCO — The phone rang, she answered it and hoped.

"Kevin Collins hotline . . . Yes . . . Thank you . . . Just a moment, let me get that down . . . thank you . . . Goodbye."

She hung up. But before she could return to the conversation, the phone rang again.

"Kevin Collins hotline . . . No . . . I'm sorry, you have the wrong number . . . Goodbye."

Ann Collins placed the telephone receiver back in its cradle.

Hundreds of calls

A month earlier, her 10-year-old son, Kevin, disappeared. Since Friday night, Feb. 10, she has answered the telphone hundreds of times. Each time she thinks, "This could be it. This could be the call."

But it hasn't happened yet. Neither Kevin's voice nor that of someone saying he has been found — dead or alive — has been heard.

This uncertainty is perhaps the most agonizing aspect of the case to the family and the most frustrating to the police. But the mystery is what has captivated the public's interest.

Not a trace

When Kevin vanished that winter evening, it was as though he slipped into some dark pool and the waters closed over him, leaving no traces.

Kevin is the sixth of Ann and David Collins' nine children. Both David and Ann attended St. Agnes School. Their roots go deep into a neighborhood that values community spirit.

The Collinses have sought to restore Kevin to their midst with a campaign of astonishing proportions.

Huge volunteer effort

Family, friends and sympathetic strangers have pitched in — some with a few hours or a few dollars, some with weeks of time, rare talent and invaluable services.

Since Kevin vanished, about 300,000 posters with his picture and description in five languages have been printed and circulated throughout the country, advertising the $10,000 reward for his safe return.

Eighteen billboards are scheduled to be erected around the Bay Area. United Artists theaters will begin showing a brief message about Kevin at the beginning of each feature as soon as the film can be provided.

Fliers and appeals have been sent to hundreds of law enforcement agencies and the media.

Door-to-door search

Police and volunteers have combed Golden Gate and Buena Vista parks and gone door to door in the Haight and along the one-and-a-quarter-mile route between St. Agnes and the Collins home.

In addition to the uniformed

See COLUMN ONE, Page A-2

Jury acquits Miami cop in shooting

The Associated Press

MIAMI — An all-white jury last night acquitted a Hispanic policeman of manslaughter in the fatal shooting of a black man, triggering violence, arson and looting that resulted in two injuries to police and scores of arrests, authorities said.

Mayor Maurice Ferre said the disturbance was "not as severe" as the rioting in 1980 and 1982, and warned that police would use "whatever force is necessary" to keep order.

The verdict in the eight-week trial of Officer Luis Alvarez was reached two hours and two minutes into deliberations by the three-man, three-woman Circuit Court jury.

Alvarez, 24, was charged with manslaughter with a firearm in the fatal shooting Dec. 28, 1982 of Nevell Johnson Jr. at a video arcade in the predominantly black Overtown section of Miami. The shooting triggered a three-day race riot.

When the verdict was read by the clerk, Alvarez leaped from his seat, spread his arms and shouted in joy and hugged his attorney.

Members of the Johnson family, some crying uncontrollably, were ushered from the courtroom, whispering, "no comment, no comment."

Alvarez and his attorneys were ushered from the courtroom at the Metro Justice Building by a phalanx of plain-clothes security men.

As the Johnsons left the building, Johnson's mother, Marlyn Johnson, implored sobbing relatives to "hold it up. Don't worry about it. God will take care of it."

Even before the verdict was announced, police hit the street with riot gear.

Two officers patrolling a black area suffered minor injuries from flying glass in the violence that followed the verdict, and were released after treatment at Jackson Memorial Hospital, said hospital spokeswoman Betty Baderman. Authorities at first said one officer had suffered a gunshot wound, but later said it was only an injury from shattered glass.

Sporadic rock- and bottle-

See MIAMI, Back Page

The Associated Press

Police officials cluster outside White House fence where man carrying sawed-off shotgun was shot.

Man had sawed-off shotgun

By The Tribune news services

WASHINGTON — A White House guard shot a man carrying a sawed-off shotgun along the fence surrounding the White House grounds last night, the Secret Service reported.

"The president's all right," said White House spokesman Larry Speakes.

The man, identified by the Secret Service as David Mahonski, 25, of Williamsport, Pa., was shot when he pointed the sawed-off shotgun at a Secret Service officer, according to Sgt. Tony Ferraro of the U.S. Park Police.

Ferraro told a news conference the man was hit in his right arm. There was one live shell in the 12-gauge, single-barrel weapon, Ferraro said.

Park Police, who patrol the area outside the White House fence, had spoken to the suspect on prior occasions when he had been seen outside the White House, Ferraro said.

Technicians who searched Mahonski's car, which was impounded near the White House, found a bow and arrow in the trunk, said Lt. Jeffrey Davis of the Park Police.

Glen R. Stom, manager of the Stroehmann Bros. Bakery in Williamsport, said Mahonski worked the night shift from January 1980 through March 1983 as a maintence mechanic.

Wayne Newton, who is principal of Williamsport High School, said Mahonski attended high school until 1974 but left before graduation. Newton also said that Mahonski attended Williamsport Area Community College.

A neighbor, Douglas White, described Mahonski as "an ordinary kid" and that "we hadn't seen him around for a while." White's wife said Mahonski "was a friendly neighbor" and the 1982 edition of Polk's information directory said Mahonski was living with his parents.

It was the second incident of the day at the White House. Earlier, a man was apprehended after climbing a fence and entering the White House grounds.

See SHOT, Back Page

State paying overdue heating bills for poor

By Virgil Meibert
The Tribune

SACRAMENTO — The interim director of the state Office of Economic Opportunity, Chon Gutierrez, yesterday promised that a $48 million backlog of utility payments to welfare families will be cleared this month.

The Tribune has been told that administrative errors by OEO prevented some 300,000 eligible California welfare families from collecting this winter's federal home heating grants until the first payments went out March 2.

The average grant, to help poverty families offset winter heating expenses, is $143.

In another development yesterday, Gutierrez said he had canceled $1.1 million worth of pending anti-poverty contracts.

He also ordered an unspecified number of OEO employees to pay back or explain $21,000 worth of "travel advances" they have received by noon today. He confirmed that the sum includes an advance to former director Gilbert Montano Jr., who resigned last week. The Tribune was told the Montano advance amounts to $800.

The Tribune revealed in copyrighted stories last week that the Deukmejian administration's anti-poverty office was being investigated by the Department of Finance and the Auditor General's office for allegations of political favoritism in poverty grants and mismanagement of poverty funds. The matter could become the Deukmejian administration's first political scandal.

Gutierrez, a career Department of Finance executive, is heading an internal investigation ordered by Deukmejian chief of staff Steve Merksamer.

Gutierrez yesterday blamed "workload problems" for the failure of the state to mail

See POOR, Back Page

Senate votes down silent prayer bill

By T.R. Reid
The Washington Post

WASHINGTON — The Senate yesterday dealt a heavy blow to a constitutional amendment governing prayer in the public schools by rejecting a version authorizing government-sanctioned silent prayer sessions, the version that had seemed most likely to be approved.

In a vote that was skewed by unusual procedural circumstances, senators voted 61-15 to table, and thus kill, a silent prayer amendment offered by Sen. Alan J. Dixon, D-Ill. Then the Senate scheduled a final vote next Tuesday afternoon on President Reagan's version of the amendment, which would permit organized vocal prayer sessions in public school classrooms.

By delaying the final vote until next week, the Senate leadership gave the president and the evangelical Christian groups that support vocal prayer one more weekend to lobby undecided senators.

"It's not an insignificant period of time," said Sen. Lowell P. Weicker Jr., R-Conn., the leading opponent of the prayer amendments, "and the president is not an insignificant lobbyist."

Still, as Sen. Orrin G. Hatch, R-Utah, floor leader for the Reagan amendment, has said, "the odds are strongly against the president's amendment."

Both supporters and opponents of the vocal prayer amendment agree that the president is several votes — estimates range from 5 to 12

See PRAYER, Back Page

Sen. Glenn to drop out of campaign

By David Shribman
The New York Times

WASHINGTON — Sen. John Glenn, once considered the principal challenger to former Vice President Walter F. Mondale for the Democratic presidential nomination, plans to withdraw from the race, top campaign aides said yesterday.

Glenn, whose campaign is more than $2 million in debt, is not likely to endorse either of the two major remaining candidates, Sen. Gary Hart of Colorado or Mondale, at a news conference scheduled to be held here this morning, these aides said.

"Almost all the advice went in the direction of withdrawing," said one of the aides, who spoke on the condition that he not be identified, "but the decision was his."

These aides said they expected that Glenn, 62, would assume a more visible role in the Senate than he had taken in the past. They speculated that he would run for re-election when his term expires in 1986.

Glenn's decision followed a day of conferences both at his Maryland home and in his Senate office with his aides, with major contributors and with his wife, Annie. Throughout that time he declined to respond to reporters' inquiries about the destiny of his campaign.

Although Glenn fell from the first tier of candidates after his fifth-place finish in the Iowa precinct caucuses and his third-place finish in the New Hampshire primary, he remained in the race with the

See GLENN, Back Page

Trib poll on smoking

Eighty percent of those responding to The Tribune's new telephone opinion poll believe that smoking should be restricted in the workplace.

Typical of those in the majority was the caller who said non-smokers have the right "not to breathe unfiltered smoke."

On the other side, one man said he didn't believe restrictions should be legislated.

And there were those who favored more consideration for both smokers and non-smokers.

Story, Page B-7

INDEX

Astrology F-9
Bridge F-9
Classified C-5
Comics F-10
Crossword F-9
Editorials B-6
Entertainment D-7
Funerals C-7
Janet Kessel D-1
Ann Landers F-9
Dave Newhouse F-1
Opinion B-7
Robin Orr C-2
Pastimes F-9
Brenda Payton B-5
Perry Phillips D-5
Television D-4
TRIBingo C-7
Weather A-10

Vol. 111-76 ★★H

DIGEST

Senate GOPs try to pry arms for Central America and food relief for drought-stricken Africa apart. A-3.

Eastbay delegate slates for Democratic candidates are packed with state legislators, local officials and grass-roots organizers. A-4.

Police round up 2,116 fugitives in a 10-week California dragnet that made use of "sting" operations and old-fashioned shoe leather. A-5.

China says it will return to strong central control over its foreign trade to end competition among Chinese companies. A-6.

Fruit and vegetables in Bay Area markets may contain more pesticides than the state is reporting, a new study finds. B-1.

San Ramon teachers prepare to strike if contract talks don't get moving, while in nearby Mt. Diablo teachers accept a new contract. B-1.

Public officials and colleagues memorialize respected journalist Leona Ward who is dead at 72. B-2.

Boeing announced it and three Japanese firms are looking into the joint development of a new, advanced fuel-efficient jetliner. C-1.

Jordan's queen visits with her American family, D-2.

The Park Bellevue's new owners say they'll sell units in the 26-story tower near Lake Merritt as condos. C-1.

For those who know rock, and even for those who don't, "This is Spinal Tap" is a hilarious send-up of the world of rock 'n' roll. D-1.

Boran Thai restaurant, on Solano Avenue, is where the flavors of Thai cuisine enchant the palate. D-1.

Oregon State lost with three seconds to go and Fresno State also was eliminated in the first round of the NCAA basketball tournament. F-1.

State and local educators continue to conduct an extensive debate over lowered standards and expectations in the schools. Opinion. B-7.

WEATHER

Mostly fair in the morning, then increasing clouds by afternoon. A chance of rain tonight, but clearing tomorrow after a chance of morning showers. A-10.